Reading practice booklet: Grade 2 expectations

Grade 2 · Practice booklet

Name: _____

What this booklet is

This is general practice written for Reading at Grade 2 level, following the Common Core State Standards for English Language Arts standards for that grade. It is not made from your child's MAP questions, and it does not replace the classroom. Use it as a guide to what a child is expected to know and do at this level.

How to use it

- Do one section at a time, about 10 minutes, 3 days a week. Stop while it is still enjoyable.
- Read each question all the way through, twice, before answering. Underline the key words and say what is being asked.
- Take your time. A careful, correct answer is worth more than a fast one.
- Use scrap paper and show the working. Then check the answer before moving on.
- Ask your child to explain how they got an answer, even when it is right.
- If a section feels too hard, do the section before it again, or ask the teacher. That is part of learning, not a problem.

Section 1: Sounds, letters and decoding

Standards practised: RF.2.3a, RF.2.3b, RF.2.3c, RF.2.3d, RF.2.3e, RF.2.3f, RF.2.4c

A worked example

Split the word "basket" into syllables.

1. Clap the word as you say it: bas-ket. You clap two times.
2. Each clap is one syllable, and each syllable has a vowel sound.

bas-ket (2 syllables)

Questions

1. Which word has the long e sound spelled with the vowel team "ea": bread, bead or bear?

2. Which vowel team is in the word "boat"?

3. Which word has the same vowel sound as "farm": cart, cat or cake?

4. Which word has the same vowel sound as "bird": hurt, hot or hat?

5. How many syllables are in the word "camel"?

6. Split the word "market" into its two syllables.

7. What is the prefix in the word "unlock"?

8. What is the suffix in the word "helpful"?

9. Which common word does not follow the usual sound pattern: said, sad or sand?

---

10. Which word ends in the sound /t/ when you say the -ed ending: jumped, wanted or played?

---

11. You read a sentence aloud and one word does not make sense. What should you do?

Section 2: Understanding what you read

Standards practised: RL.2.1, RL.2.2, RL.2.3, RL.2.5, RI.2.1, RI.2.2, RI.2.3, RL.2.6, RL.2.7, RL.2.9, RI.2.7, RI.2.8, RI.2.9

A worked example

Read: "Noura put on her coat because the desert night was cold." Why did Noura put on her coat?

1. Find the word because. It tells us the reason.
2. The reason comes after because: the desert night was cold.

Because the desert night was cold.

Text A: Dates for Eid

On Friday morning, Maryam and her cousin Hamdan went with Grandmother to a date farm in Al Ain. The air was warm. The palm trees stood in long, straight rows. Grandmother wanted to pick dates to make sweets for Eid. Maryam carried a basket, and Hamdan held a small ladder.

"Pick only the soft, brown dates," said Grandmother. The children worked carefully and filled the basket. Soon it was heavy.

Then Hamdan saw a tired little bird sitting in the shade. It looked thirsty. He did not touch it. Instead, he called Grandmother, and she poured some water into a small dish. The bird drank, rested, and flew away.

"That was kind and gentle," said Grandmother. "When we help quietly, we make the world better."

The children carried the heavy basket home, smiling all the way.

Text B: The Date Palm

The date palm is a tall tree that grows well in hot, dry places. Its long roots reach deep underground to find water.

How Dates Grow First, small flowers open on the tree in spring. Next, the flowers turn into green dates. Then the dates change colour as they get bigger. Last, they become soft and brown, and farmers harvest them.

Many Uses For many years, people in the Emirates have used every part of the palm. The fruit is food. The leaves can be woven into mats and fans. The trunk gives wood for building.

Glossary harvest: to pick a crop when it is ready

Text C: The Lost Kite (Salem and Noura)

Salem and his sister Noura flew a red kite on the beach in Sharjah while Mother sat on a bench nearby. The wind was strong. It pulled the string out of Salem's hand, and the kite landed at the top of a tall palm tree.

"Oh no, my kite is lost!" said Salem. He felt very worried.

"Don't worry," said Noura in a happy voice. "We can get it back."

Mother found a long stick and reached up. The kite came down, and Salem held the string tight. "Thank you," he said. "Next time I will hold it with both hands."

Text D: The Lost Kite (Hamdan and Layla)

Hamdan and his cousin Layla flew a green kite in the desert near Hatta while Grandfather sat in the shade of a ghaf tree. The wind was strong. It pulled the string out of Hamdan's hand, and the kite landed on a branch of the ghaf tree.

"I think it is too high," said Layla in a small voice.

"Let us try," said Hamdan in a brave voice. "We will find a way."

Grandfather found a long stick and reached up. The kite came down, and Hamdan held the string tight. "Thank you," he said. "Next time I will hold it with both hands."

Text E: Solar Parks

A solar park is a large place filled with rows of solar panels. Solar panels catch sunlight and turn it into electricity. Homes, schools and shops use that electricity for lights and fans.

The UAE is a good place for solar parks because it has many sunny days. Solar panels use sunlight, so they make electricity without making smoke. This helps keep the air clean, so solar parks are a good choice for the country.

Questions

1. Who went to the date farm with Grandmother?

2. Where is the date farm?

3. What did Hamdan see in the shade?

4. Why did Grandmother pour water into a small dish?

5. How did the children pick the dates?

6. Which sentence tells the main idea of the story: (a) Dates grow in Al Ain. (b) Two cousins helped a thirsty bird while they picked dates. (c) Eid sweets are made with dates.

7. What lesson does Grandmother teach at the end of the story?

8. Put these in the order they happen: the bird drinks water; the children pick dates; the children carry the basket home.

9. Read Text B. Why can the date palm grow well in hot, dry places?

10. What is the main topic of Text B: (a) how to bake Eid sweets, (b) the date palm, how it grows and how it is used, or (c) a trip to a farm in Al Ain?

11. In Text B, what happens right after the small flowers open?

12. Text A and Text B are both about dates. Which idea is in Text B but not in Text A: (a) Dates are soft and brown when ready. (b) Palm leaves can be woven into mats and fans. (c) Children can help pick dates.

13. In Text C, who feels worried at first, and who feels sure the kite can be saved?

14. In Text D, which character says the kite is too high, and which character wants to try?

15. A picture next to Text C shows a red kite stuck at the top of a tall palm tree, with Salem pointing up and Mother holding a long stick. Which part of the story does the picture match best: (a) the kite landing in the tree and the plan to reach it, (b) Salem saying thank you, or (c) the children arriving at the beach?

16. Text C and Text D are two versions of the same story. What happens to the kite in both of them?

17. Text C and Text D are two versions of the same story. Name one way Text D is different from Text C.

---

18. A diagram below Text E shows the sun at the top, an arrow down to a solar panel, and a second arrow from the panel to a light bulb. What does the second arrow show?

---

19. A photo beside Text E shows many flat panels in long rows, all tilted to face the sun. Which part of the text does the photo match best: (a) the first sentence about rows of solar panels, or (b) the last sentence about clean air?

---

20. What reason does the author give for the UAE being a good place for solar parks?

Section 3: Word meanings and how writers use words

Standards practised: L.2.4a, L.2.4b, L.2.4d, L.2.5b, RL.2.4, RI.2.4, RI.2.5, RI.2.6

A worked example

Read: "The path was narrow, so only one camel could walk on it at a time." What does narrow mean?

1. Look for clues near the word. Only one camel could fit on the path.
2. A path where only one fits is not wide.

Narrow means not wide.

Text A: Rain in the Desert

Drip, drip, drop, the rain comes down, Over the sand and the sleepy town. Drip, drip, drop, on the palm tree tall, The thirsty ground drinks it all. Splash, splash, splash, the puddles play, The sun comes out and we cheer, hooray!

Text B: The Hope Probe

A Journey to Mars The Hope Probe is a spacecraft built in the United Arab Emirates. In 2021 it reached Mars and began to circle the planet. It is an orbiter, which means it travels around a planet instead of landing on it.

What Hope Studies The probe uses special tools to study the weather and the air of Mars. Scientists share what it finds so that people everywhere can learn about the red planet.

Glossary orbiter: a spacecraft that circles a planet

Questions

1. "The soup was scalding. Layla waited because it could burn her tongue." What does scalding mean?

---

2. What does the word "unhappy" mean?

3. What does the word "unlock" mean?

4. What does the word "rewrite" mean?

5. Omar will reread his book tonight. What will he do?

6. Which two small words make the compound word "sandstorm"?

7. Which word is a compound word: sandy, sandcastle or sandal?

8. Which word means almost the same as "huge": tiny, giant or quiet?

9. Which word is the opposite of "empty": full, open or small?

10. Put these words in order from least hot to most hot: boiling, warm, hot.

11. Which word shows the fastest way to move: stroll, hurry or wander?

12. Explain why "happy" and "unhappy" are opposites. What does the prefix do?

13. In the poem in Text A, which word at the end of line 2 rhymes with "down" at the end of line 1? What does the repeated "drip, drip, drop" help you hear?

14. In Text B, what does the word "orbiter" mean?

---

15. Which part of Text B would you read to find out what the Hope Probe studies: the heading "A Journey to Mars", the heading "What Hope Studies" or the Glossary?

---

16. What is the main purpose of Text B: (a) to make you laugh, (b) to tell you facts about the Hope Probe, or (c) to ask you to buy something?

Section 4: Writing and language

Standards practised: L.2.1b, L.2.1f, L.2.2a, L.2.2b, L.2.2c, W.2.3

A worked example

Write the plural of the word "foot".

1. Most plurals add s, but some words change a different way.
2. We do not say foots. The word changes inside: foot becomes feet.

feet

Questions

1. Rewrite this sentence with the correct capital letters: omar visited abu dhabi on friday.

2. Add the missing comma to the end of this letter closing: Your friend

3. Rewrite with the correct capital letters: the children celebrated eid in sharjah.

4. Add the missing comma to the start of this letter: Dear Layla

5. Write "do not" as one word, using an apostrophe.

6. Write "we are" as one word, using an apostrophe.

7. Use an apostrophe to show that the bag belongs to Noura.

8. Write the plural of "child".

9. Write the plural of "tooth".

---

10. Which is a complete sentence: (a) The big camel. (b) The camel drank water.

---

11. Which sentence is the best way to make "The boy ran." longer: (a) The boy ran. (b) The happy boy ran quickly to the souq. (c) Ran quickly the.

---

12. Put these sentences in order to tell a story: Finally he said thank you. First Salem washed his hands. Then Salem ate his lunch.

Answer guide for parents

Section 1: Sounds, letters and decoding

1. bead (in "bread" the ea says a short e, and in "bear" it says air).
2. oa (the letters o and a work together to say a long o).
3. cart (the letters ar in both words make the same r-controlled sound).
4. hurt (ir and ur both make the same sound).
5. 2 (cam-el).
6. mar-ket.
7. un- (it comes at the start of the word and means not or the opposite).
8. -ful (it comes at the end of the word).
9. said (the ai in said makes a short e sound, not a long a).
10. jumped (wanted ends in the sound /id/ and played ends in /d/).
11. Go back and reread the sentence, looking at the word again, until it makes sense.

Section 2: Understanding what you read

1. Maryam and her cousin Hamdan.
2. In Al Ain.
3. A tired, thirsty little bird.
4. Because the bird looked thirsty.
5. Carefully (they picked only the soft, brown ones).
6. (b) (it tells what the whole story is about, not just one detail).
7. When we help others quietly and kindly, we make the world better (be kind and helpful).
8. 1. The children pick dates. 2. The bird drinks water. 3. The children carry the basket home.
9. Its long roots reach deep underground to find water.
10. (b) (the whole text tells facts about the date palm).
11. They turn into green dates (the word next shows the order).
12. (b) (Text A tells about soft, brown dates and children picking them, but only Text B tells about using the leaves).
13. Salem feels worried, and Noura feels sure (she says "Don't worry" in a happy voice).
14. Layla says it is too high, and Hamdan wants to try (each character has a different point of view).
15. (a) (the picture shows the kite in the tree and the long stick, so it helps us see the problem and how it will be solved).
16. The wind pulls the string away and the kite lands in a tree, then a long stick is used to bring it down.
17. Any one of these: it is set in the desert near Hatta, not on a beach in Sharjah; the children are Hamdan and Layla, not Salem and Noura; the kite is green, not red; Grandfather helps, not Mother.
18. The electricity made by the panel goes to the light bulb (it gives the bulb power).
19. (a) (the photo shows what a solar park looks like, with panels in rows).
20. It has many sunny days.

Section 3: Word meanings and how writers use words

1. Very hot (the clue is that it could burn her tongue).
2. Not happy (the prefix un- means not).
3. To open a lock, to undo locking (the prefix un- means the opposite of).
4. To write again (the prefix re- means again).
5. Read his book again.
6. sand and storm.
7. sandcastle (it is made of sand and castle).
8. giant.
9. full.
10. warm, hot, boiling.
11. hurry (stroll and wander are relaxed ways of moving).
12. Un- means not, so unhappy means not happy, the opposite of happy.
13. town rhymes with down. The repeated words give a steady beat and help you hear raindrops falling.
14. A spacecraft that circles (travels around) a planet. The text and the glossary both say so.
15. The heading "What Hope Studies" (headings tell what each part is about).
16. (b) (the author wants to explain and describe the Hope Probe).

Section 4: Writing and language

1. Omar visited Abu Dhabi on Friday.
2. Your friend,
3. The children celebrated Eid in Sharjah.
4. Dear Layla,
5. don't.
6. we're.
7. Noura's bag.
8. children.
9. teeth.
10. (b) (it tells who and what happened; (a) is only part of a sentence).
11. (b) (it adds a describing word, how he ran and where).
12. First Salem washed his hands. Then Salem ate his lunch. Finally he said thank you.